

9.3.6.3 “Trust, Cool, Sexy, Fan” Ranking

These refer to the opinions that other members have about a member on those criteria—Trustworthiness, Coolness, Sexiness, Ability to Awe. There are no formal verification procedures for these rankings, of course. But a member who has received high trust rankings from many friends can be safely expected to be trustworthy. In the same vein, someone who has been ranked high on “Coolness” and “Sexiness” can be expected to be a Jon Abraham look-alike and not a bespectacled geek.

9.3.6.4 Testimonials

This is what a member’s friends have to say about him. But unlike scraps, these comments can be vetted by the member before they are posted, and only friends can post testimonials.

9.3.7 Initiating dialogue

After you have found a person who has the tastes and personality traits you’re looking for, you can initiate dialogue by requesting to be considered as that member’s friend. For this, use the “Add as a friend” link.

The Member is notified of your request and is given the freedom to reciprocate or spurn your overture. Having a descriptive profile of yourself doubtless improves your chances of acceptance. You can also send a message to that Member, introducing yourself, by using the Send Message Link. The Send Teaser link offers the same functionality as Send Message, but adds some mystery. It is best reserved for members of the opposite sex you are planning on befriending.

9.3.8 Maintaining Relationships

Once you have made friends, you can add testimonials or rate them on the various parameters like trust, cool, etc., making it easier for others to judge them before offering a hand of friendship. Friends can be categorised based on their emotional and physical proximity to you as best friends, good friends, and so on. Friends can also be categorised into groups: Business Contacts, for example, can be clas-